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23 DAYS 5 HOURS 34 MINUTES 42 SECONDS
UNTIL HALLOWEEN!

Converting a Gemmy "try me" button to always on?

[→ Jump to Latest](#) 18K views  6 replies**E****Eltis** OP

45 posts · Joined 2009

#1 · Sep 28, 2009

Greetings,

I have a 5' crawling girl from [Spirit](#). By default, she has 2 settings. One is sensor, the other is "on". "On" doesn't mean she is always running - it means that you can press the manual button on her arm and she will then go at it.

What I want to do is modify her so that the "on" really does mean always on. That way, I can control her activation via power (I have an outlet that I can control remotely). Is this easily done? Is it even possible?

What I've tried:

I tried cutting the 2 wires connected to the button and splicing them together. This did not work.

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**bayork**

179 posts · Joined 2003

#2 · Oct 2, 2009

Bueller...Bueller?

Someone has to know the answer to this...I'll add my voice as yet another newbie to hacking the electronics in Gemmys that could REALLY use this pearl of information.

I have a Gemmy Drop-Down Skull that I did exactly the same thing with...cut the two wires to the button...spliced them together...and nothing.

Master of Screamyard Cemetery[My Haunt pics at Photobucket](#)

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**E****Eltis** **OP**

45 posts · Joined 2009

#3 · Oct 2, 2009

Yeah, I was a little surprised that nobody has the answer to this. Maybe people just don't check this section of the forum much - I'm sure somebody knows how to do it.

I'm leading people through our [haunted house](#) personally, so it would really help to be able to trigger props through a wireless outlet on/off controller instead of the sensor (or worse, having to walk up to the prop and pinch its arm). The sensor is unreliable anyway due to the lighting conditions.



Reply



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**frugal ghoul**

163 posts · Joined 2005

#4 · Oct 2, 2009

I've found that it takes the motion of the button being pressed and released to trigger em, or so it seems. An easier solution i have used is one of those blinking xmas bulbs, ya know the ones with the red [stripe](#) that come with the string of lights. You can wire that up to a 3-6 volt wall wart and then control that with your wireless controller. Hope that helps.



Reply



Like

**bayork**

179 posts · Joined 2003

#5 · Oct 2, 2009

Thanks, frugal ghoul.

My solution at this point is to put the prop on "ON" and use a strobe to trigger the prop's sensor.

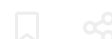
I had PLANNED on hooking the "try me" wires to a 120v DPDT relay plugged into an X10 appliance module. Using that, I could then use a X10 remote to turn on/off the strobe AND the prop at the same time. The net effect of using the strobe to trigger the prop is a momentary delay before the skull animates, but it's still pretty acceptable.

Hopefully, more people have solved this and we'll get more solutions that we can mull over and pick between.

Master of Screamyard Cemetery

[My Haunt pics at Photobucket](#)

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Mack Bolan

1 post · Joined 2009

#6 · Oct 4, 2009

I've struggled with the same thing

I build a walk through haunted house in my garage each year and last year I bought some of the animatronic props from Spirit Halloween store, Menards etc and found that when in the dark with only black lights the sensors for auto triggering them do not work reliably.

I'm kicking myself this year because when I went to Spirit at the end of last season they had a bunch of the big red 'Try Me' buttons from their displays with long wires too, and I forgot to ask if they would give or sell them to me as the displays were already sold.

I've got to believe these are just low voltage simple circuits that you would build from parts at Radio Shack or something. I'm going to try this in the next couple of weeks, if I have any success I'll share.

Last year what I did was set up strobes in the displays and this just constantly triggered them but it's not as nice as if they go off when the person approaches.

Good to know I'm not the only one.

 Reply  Like



bayork

179 posts · Joined 2003

#7 · Oct 7, 2009

It turns out that using X10 to trigger the strobes remotely works double-duty to sound-activate my skull. The click of the appliance module when it switches on makes a noise loud enough to register.

..so for ONCE, that sound is useful, instead of just annoying!

(still would prefer direct control. Hope you figure it out!)

Master of Screamyard Cemetery

[My Haunt pics at Photobucket](#)



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A

Halloween Props
Amon · Oct 28, 2008

Electronic/Software: Gemmy Bride and Groom

Ok... i bought the Bride and Groom. I can rewire the bride to a press to test switch that can be operated yards away but the Groom doesn't come with a try me button that I can splice into. My question is this:...

1 895

Amon replied Oct 28, 2008



Halloween Props
MichaelMyers1 · Oct 30, 2008

Electronic/Software: Blinking Ghoul HELP PLEASE?

Ok, so a few weeks ago I bought this hanging goul with flashing eyes. When I tried him out at the store, it had one of those "try me" buttons....you push the button and the lights blink for about 15 seconds. I...

2 1K

Shrimp_Toast replied Oct 30, 2008



General Halloween
tinafromidaho · Sep 27, 2009

step pads at spirit

Has anyone seen the step pads at the spirit store? Any ideas where to get something like that? according to the kid I asked they don't sell them. But they just plug into the hole where any try me button was...

3 1.1K

OpenTrackRacer replied Sep 28, 2009



Halloween Props
bayork · Oct 2, 2009

Electronic/Software: What's the secret to hacking Gemmy "Try ME" buttons...?

I'm assuming that much fewer people go into the "request for Tutorials" sub-forum over in the Tutorials section. My apologies if this really isn't the case. (....Halloween is LOOMING and at least two of us have...

6 10K

bayork replied Oct 3, 2009

R

Halloween Props
rickdilorenzo · Oct 4, 2009

Spirit - Foot Pad Activator???

Foot Pad Activator in Decorations There is *no* description for this..what does it do? Can you connect it to the try-me cable on the Spirit Animatronics to activate them like a pressure mat?? It's only \$4.99 so...

48 15K

APK replied Oct 23, 2009

S

General Halloween
SolaraLover · Oct 7, 2009

Clown head that talks..help

I picked up a Clown head from SPIRIT a few weeks back, it talks and is sound activated. It has 3-5 sayings and they all run in the same order, with no break at all in between the sayings. Is there a way to...

0 586

SolaraLover replied Oct 7, 2009



Halloween Props
Ghost of Spookie · Oct 7, 2009

Electronic/Software: Gemmy's Boney Barney Skeleton Dog

Picked up Target's variation of the Gemmy Boney Barney Skeleton Dog last night. Reg. 19.99 but on sale this week for \$15.99. He was the last one of the shelf (their sale this week has cleared out a lot of...

3 5.5K

Baby Jane replied Oct 13, 2009

M

Halloween Props
monkeypeng · Oct 11, 2009

Static: Help with Store Bought Tombstones

I bought 3 tall tombstones that light up. They came with the "Try Me" button and worked fine until I replaced the batteries with fresh, new batteries before putting outside. Now they won't work at all, eve...

5 1.6K

monkeypeng replied Oct 12, 2009



Halloween Props

tinafromidaho · Oct 26, 2009

need help making a pressure mat

I have a prop thats a guy in a coffin using 9vdc and he sits up in his little coffin and talks to people. he has a little try me button that someone has to stand and push to trigger him as the sensor on him doesn...

16 3.5K

Mainelyelectric replied May 4, 2010



Halloween Props

tinafromidaho · Oct 26, 2009

Electronic/Software: I desperately need pressure mat help

I have a prop thats a guy in a coffin using 9vdc and he sits up in his little coffin and talks to people. he has a little try me button that someone has to stand and push to trigger him as the sensor on him doesn...

1 704

Otaku replied Oct 26, 2009

M

Halloween Props

ManicXellos · Oct 30, 2009

Lighting: LED strobe light timer?

Every year I put out a pirate ship, and have been using plug in strobe lights for the light of the cannon fire. This has worked ok, but it seems that the bulbs in the strobe lights burn out after only one use....

0 4.3K

ManicXellos replied Oct 30, 2009



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FeelNecro · Sep 18, 2010

Hacking a "Try Me" Button

I would like to put a "Hedge Shaker" into the chest of one of my zombies but the one I bought is "sound" activated. Is there any way to convert it to "motion" activated ? I thought maybe the wires from the try ...

5 2.3K

Crunch replied Sep 20, 2010

**General Halloween**

Antimars · Sep 19, 2010

A Reminder that the Spirit is Alive and Well

Okay so...the other day my mother was renewing registration on her car at the DMV. I was given permission to not accompany her so instead I wandered across the street to the Spirit store convenientl...

13 1.9K

Junit replied Sep 27, 2010

**General Halloween**

ZombieRaider · Sep 26, 2010

All Spirit stores are not created equal

Went to one in a mall last week in a town I don't visit usually just to see Spirit...It was small, most of the animatronics I wanted to see was boxed up, displays was very minimal....Not very inspiring.....Walked o...

5 796

christascandy1 replied Sep 26, 2010

**Halloween Props**

Ghost of Spookie · Feb 17, 2011

Mechanical: Animated Playskool Baby Pterodactyl toy to Baby Dragon

I stumbled upon one of these animated kids' toys from Playskool, a Pterodactyl, part of the Kota and Pals Hatchlings while at a Goodwill the other day for only 99 cents. Runs on 3AAA batteries and has an on/o...

3 3.2K

Ghost of Spookie replied Feb 17, 2011

**General Halloween**

larry · Jun 30, 2011

Try Me Button

I am very happy to have found out that because of many requests that Spirit Halloween IS going to sell their "Try Me" buttons this year. This is the button that you press to start the demo of their props when...

27 8.5K

Brandonandkayla replied Jul 7, 2011

**Halloween Props**

Markula · Aug 31, 2011

Electronic/Software: Hacking a Spirit footpad or "Try Me" button...possible?

Hey all. Relatively new to these forums, but I've found a lot of useful info from experienced haunters here, and I thought I'd try my hand with a question. I'm interested in making a motion sensor activator...

12 18K

robzilla69 replied Oct 11, 2011



Tutorials and Step-By-Step

DaveintheGrave · Aug 31, 2011

Switch Mat - Cheap and Easy

Easy Switch Mat A great way to trigger a DC powered prop, especially ones that have a "Try Me" switch.

Materials Buffalo Snow (Cotton type material) Thin Cardboard Thin electrical wire Clear Packing Tape...

0 3.9K

DaveintheGrave replied Aug 31, 2011



Halloween Props

Halloweenie315 · Sep 5, 2011

Electronic/Software: How easy/hard would this be? - Hacking Try-Me Buttons

Hi everyone. So I think I'm gonna buy the animated Grave digger from Spirit this year. Only \$112 with a coupon and I love the animation! Well, what I want to do is behind my graveyard, I have 2 windows. I...

6 1.4K

Halloweenie315 replied Sep 6, 2011

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